

NetApp acquires Instaclustr

NetApp Inc., a data storage company, has acquired the open source database startup Instaclustr Pty Ltd for an undisclosed sum.

Enterprises who don't want to handle their own software can use Instaclustr to get fully managed versions of the most popular open source databases. Its 'database as a service' platform hosts and supports a variety of open source technologies, including Apache Cassandra, Apache Kafka, Apache Spark, Apache Lucene, and ScyllaDB, among others.

NetApp, which provides companies with hybrid cloud data services and data management, said it will merge Instaclustr into its CloudOps offering after the deal closes, subject to customary closing conditions.

In a blog post, NetApp executive



vice president and general manager Anthony Lye stated that the transaction is all about improving client experiences by making open-source software installation easier. "The acquisition of Instaclustr is a strategic next step for NetApp -- to do more for the customer, simplify the experience, continuously optimize and secure the platform so customers don't have to do it themselves," he wrote.

NetApp has been on a buying spree of late, acquiring startups like Spot, CloudCheckr Inc., and, most recently, Fylamynt, in order to expand its reach into areas like cybersecurity, cloud cost control, and cloud automation. The purchases are all part of NetApp's strategy to transition from a legacy storage supplier to one that is more relevant to organisations that manage the majority of their workloads in the cloud.

For the upcoming part of the competition, semi-finalists will conduct inspection and intervention tasks in simulation, and the technology will combine previous



weather data from the Swiss firm meteoblue. Competitors will be able to access historical Abu Dhabi weather data from the past 20 years to replicate realistic weather conditions.

The simulation platform will be built on Gazebo and Robot Operating System by

Open Robotics, a global leader in software for robotics simulation and application development. Gazebo is an open source 3D robotics simulator that simulates robots for a variety of applications, including marine robotics.

Dr Ray O. Johnson, ASPIRE's acting chief executive, stated, "With Open Robotics and meteoblue, we have selected two organisations that are both at the pinnacle of their respective fields. The MBZIRC Maritime Grand Challenge will push the boundaries in maritime robotics. We are providing the competitors with a world-class simulation environment with Open Robotics and meteoblue."

"We are making all the software open source," Dr Johnson continued. "Our mission is to drive the creation of transformative technologies and encourage global collaboration to help stimulate innovation across the field of maritime robotics. Sharing the technology to help make innovation easier was our goal."

Airbyte acquires Grouparoo

Airbyte, an open source data integration platform, has acquired Grouparoo, an open source startup that helps businesses sync data between data warehouses and cloud-based applications. This compliments Airbyte's products in many respects, as Airbyte concentrates on loading data into data warehouses, whereas Grouparoo focuses on operationalising that data.

"It's an open source reverse ETL [extract, transform, load] company," Airbyte co-founder and CEO Michel Tricot said. "They focus exactly on the other direction [from Airbyte]. They have a very strong technical team and they've already built a part of the product; it's going to be about how we can leverage



everything that they've done and get them into the team to expand the Airbyte product for reverse ETL."

Airbyte isn't so much buying the product as it is the team's knowledge, according to Tricot. He stated, "We are

not integrating their technology. It's more about their knowledge and experience." Tricot also mentioned that the Grouparoo team has always focused on making its service accessible to a non-technical audience, which is something Airbyte has also been focused on for a long time (though it also offers a command-line tool for technical users that want more flexibility, too).

Brian Leonard, Grouparoo's CEO and co-founder, wrote: "Thank you to our users and investors for your continued support. Grouparoo certainly had a set of early believers and users that saw what we were trying to accomplish.